as security establishments such as police offices or army barracks. According to the South Asia Terrorism Portal, Pakistan lost 62,421 lives to violence between 2002 and 2017. The number of violent civilian deaths spiked first in 2007 with 1,522 fatalities, increasing to well over 2,000 per annum in the 2 subsequent years, spiking again to over 3,000 deaths per annum in 2012 and 2013. Since 2014 the numbers have abated slowly but killings persist, and civilians and terrorist and security personnel continue to die at unusually high rates.[2] In effect this generation of Pakistani youths have experienced more violence than any generation before them.[3] The securitization of the day-to-day lives of Pakistanis is evident not only in the changing infrastructure of cities across Pakistan but also in the ideological narrative that is being promoted by a security state. While the military is fighting the physical threat of militancy and terrorism (yet pandering to certain strategic militant groups that would serve the state's interest), the security state is also allegedly attempting to focus on a softer approach to prevent terrorism from taking root in Pakistan. According to the Pakistani state and its security apparatus, the country faces 'traditional' and 'non-traditional' forms of threats that include 'extremism, sectarianism, terrorism and militancy' (Ministry of Interior 2014, p. 5). Pakistan's Ministry of Interior has responded to these threats with a National Internal Security Policy (NISP) 2014–2018[4] that adopts a multi-agency approach in combating these 'non-traditional' threats, and has included a 'soft component' through a 'Comprehensive Support Plan (CRP)' that will attempt to win the 'trust and confidence of general public to combat extremism and terrorism' (Ministry of Interior 2014, p. 6). In order to win this 'trust and confidence' NISP 2014–2018 has proposed the need for a national narrative to be constructed and promoted through the NACTA of Pakistan:

> An effective communication campaign will be of utmost importance and NACTA will be making all efforts to take NISP to all stakeholders and construct positive public opinion through integrated efforts. However, this is only possible if all key pillars of the state are prepared to develop a unified narrative and support each other for building a better future for the People of Pakistan. (p. 45)

In taking on board these different stakeholders, from civil society, academia, media, military and religious figures, the Ministry of Interior has formulated the NCEPG, with a focus on a strategy called 'CONNECT' that aims to reinforce citizens' confidence in the state, which is considered to be one of the reasons why Pakistanis are being radicalized (NACTA 2018). This chapter first examines terrorism in the various settings in Pakistan, looking at terror linked to sectarian groups, their effects across cities and the provinces before